

What is Liber Primus?

I've spent a long time thinking about what the author of this puzzle wanted to convey to people back in 2014, and I'd like to share my thoughts with this community in detail.

First, I believe Liber Primus was created by a truly brilliant person, without exaggeration—someone who knew in advance that the puzzle would not be solved for at least another ten years. I'll explain why below, and you'll see what I mean. The author was likely looking for people in 2012–2013 to help technically release the puzzle online in 2014. That gives us the number 3, the year 2014, and a recurring play around the number 14. I'm convinced he/she was completely serious about what he/she was doing.

So what is Liber Primus? I see it as a true work of art, created by one person and his collaborators. Its difficulty does not come from an absurdly complex cipher, but from the fusion of form and meaning. What impresses me most about the author is ability to design the experience of another mind. He/she must have been thinking something like this:

1. "At this point, the solver already knows I and $\phi(I)$."
2. "So now I can use 10 and 4 without giving a new instruction."
3. "He will reach this point and find NG."
4. "NG will then give him 12."
5. "12 must reveal two things at once, otherwise the transition will feel arbitrary."
6. "When he gets COLD, he should realize that the previous steps were not accidental."

In other words, the author is modeling the future solver's state of knowledge in his own mind. He/she did not simply hide a message, but designed a sequence of discoveries. And that may mean the true object of Cicada is not even the final plaintext. The real object is the path by which a person reaches it. In a normal cipher, the final plaintext is the goal: symbols $\rightarrow$ key $\rightarrow$ message. Done. Here, it may be different. The solver is forced to repeatedly change how he perceives the object and follow a specific intellectual path. The final English phrase is only one layer. The second is understanding the rules of the world the author built. The third may be psychological: learning to abandon your initial assumptions, notice things an algorithm would ignore without context, and gradually see the structure the way its creator did. That is why I think Liber Primus may be closer to a work of art. You are not simply given a hidden message—you are guided through a deliberately designed experience of discovering it. Changing your perception may not be a side effect of the puzzle's difficulty, but one of its actual purposes.

You are not told to lose certainty or change perspective—you are forced to experience it. The object remains unsolvable until your way of seeing it changes. That may be the purpose of the "maze": not

distance from the exit, but the sequence of uncertainty, choice, error, discovery, and new understanding. The solver gradually builds an internal map of the rules—first almost nothing makes sense, then $\phi(\text{center})$ matters, numbers define movement, three-rune symmetries become nodes, and old values return in new stages. Eventually, chaos becomes a system. The object has not changed; the person looking at it has. The map alone is not enough—you have to change along the way to learn how to read it. Beyond that, I suspect a deeper purpose. If the author was interested in knowledge and truth, the puzzle may be demonstrating a simple idea: data does not contain one obvious meaning on its own; meaning depends on the model through which you interpret it. That is a deep idea in both mathematics and science, where major discoveries often come not from new data, but from seeing old data through a different framework.

Yes, this may sound strange or even crazy, especially because no one in this community seems to have approached Liber Primus from this angle before. But I genuinely feel that I understand the author's intent, and that this may be what Liber Primus actually is. Many people resist this perspective because they cannot accept that the way forward may have no single rule, no five-second Python script, and no simple formula that reveals the entire text. It is a very thin thread of understanding, but read my reasoning carefully again and you may reach the same conclusion. Anyone who truly wants to help should be willing to change perspective. In a sense, we have to die—as strange as that sounds: our old way of seeing the puzzle has to disappear.

I can continue alone, but I would rather have people beside me who can think unconventionally, look into this abyss, step outside every familiar framework, and search for the way forward together. And to those criticizing my findings: try giving the file above, together with these messages as context, to a powerful AI and ask it to evaluate the work fairly. If my reasoning seems meaningless to you, perhaps an independent analysis from an advanced model will at least make it worth reconsidering. I also realized that I cannot force this perspective on anyone. Whoever reads this can decide for themselves how close I may be to the truth, and you can return here at any time. I will keep trying to move forward, and of course, any help is always welcome.